All businesses, establishments, restaurants, malls and public places remained shut. Only essential and frontline workers stepped out of their homes. The usually buzzing streets went silent, with not a man in sight. At 5.00 in the evening, people came to their balconies and doorsteps to applaud and show their gratitude for the services of the doctors, nurses and essential workers who were risking their lives, akin to soldiers fighting a war at the border. Social media was abuzz with images and videos from the length and breadth of the country. From celebrities, politicians and sportspersons to the last man standing outside a small, remote hutment with a broken roof—each Indian showed this collective spirit of unity. It was a reminder for us of our grit, determination and fighting spirit; that we were all in this together. India's spirit to fight and its spirit to conquer were in full display at 5.00 p.m. for five minutes, on 22 March 2020. The prime minister's plan for his message to reach out to every single Indian was a success.

During a briefing with his communications team, the prime minister expressed that he would like to receive two media reports a day going forward for his briefings, versus a single daily report. He specifically instructed them that the reports should be segmented as per the broader subjects of the empowered groups. The team henceforth would submit their media reports to him at 1.30 p.m. every afternoon and then again at 8.00 p.m. The briefing would include global news reports (from media and social media) of best practices and problems that various governments were encountering and overcoming, adversities that people within the country would face on account of the new curbs as well as remarks from the ground situation. He further instructed that he would like to keep communication channels to him and the PMO as open as possible in order to receive and respond to public grievances. If he came across any complaints in his briefings, his team would further send it to the empowered groups, who would then need to act on it immediately and submit to the PMO an action-taken report within 24 hours. Not only did he indicate that he would be personally very involved with this, but he also made it the PMO's mandate to solve these issues on-ground very quickly on a real-time basis.